

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Complete Purification of All Karmic Obscurations'

Ārya-sarva-karma-āvaraṇa-viśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 743 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལས་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་ཅད་རྣམ་པར་སྦྱོབ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུད་གྲུས་

Toh 743 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-sarva-karma-āvaraṇa-viśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa lé kyi dribpa tamché nampar jangwa shyejawé zung, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Complete Purification of All Karmic Obscurations.'" It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a sacred mantra formula associated with the buddha Akṣobhya, the Imperturbable, whose purifying power it invokes. The text prescribes the recitation and ritual use of this dhāraṇī as a means of cleansing karmic obscurations of varying severity, including even the gravest transgressions known as the five acts of immediate retribution, as well as dispelling bad omens, evil dreams, and inauspicious signs.

In the Indian language: Ārya-sarva-karma-āvaraṇa-viśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Complete Purification of All Karmic Obscurations."

Homage to the Blessed One, the Imperturbable (Akṣobhya).

Namo ratnatrayāya. Oṃ kaṃkani kaṃkani, rocani rocani, troṭani troṭani, trāsani trāsani, pratihana pratihana, sarva-karma-param parāṇi me svāhā.

The prescribed use of this dhāraṇī mantra is as follows.

If one recites it continuously, all karmic transmissions passing from one life to the next will be completely purified. If one recites it three times a day, even the five acts of immediate retribution will be cleansed. If one recites it even once, bad omens, evil dreams, and inauspicious signs will all be dispelled. If one carries it on the body or writes it on a scroll and wears it around the neck, untimely death will never befall that person.

If one is moved by compassion and recites it into the ear of any dying being — whether a wild animal, a bird, a human, or a non-human — that being will not be reborn in the lower realms. Or if a being has already died and passed beyond its time, one calls out the name of the deceased and then, out of loving-kindness and compassion, recites the mantra one hundred, one thousand, or one hundred thousand times: even if that sentient being has

already been born in a hell realm, it will be liberated from that very moment.

If one recites the mantra over earth, sesame seeds, white mustard seeds, or water — whichever is at hand — and scatters it over the body of the deceased, or bathes the corpse and afterwards cremates it, or places the mantra inside a stūpa, or writes the spell and ties it to the head of the deceased: even one who has been born in the lower realms will, within seven days, without any doubt whatsoever, be liberated and reborn in a fortunate higher realm of the gods. Alternatively, by the power of their own aspiration, they will be reborn accordingly.

If, on the day of the full moon, one bathes and purifies oneself, changes one's clothing three times daily, refrains from eating — or else eats only white food with restraint — and circumambulates a stūpa containing relics while reciting the mantra one hundred thousand times in the name of whomever one designates: that being will be liberated from the lower realms, will be reborn in the pure divine realm, will come before the practitioner, offer reverence, manifest their body, and say "Excellent!" — and having said this, will circumambulate three times and then vanish from sight.

If one writes the name of such a being and recites this dhāraṇī mantra, then constructs one hundred thousand stūpas and makes fine offerings with parasols, victory banners, pennants, and the like, and releases them into the great ocean or into a river: that being will be liberated from the hells and from all the lower realms.

Or, having performed the offerings in that way, if one then erects a great stūpa at a crossroads at the end of the road, adorns it beautifully with parasols, victory banners, pennants, and the like, hosts a feast for the noble Saṅgha, presents offerings to them, makes excellent offerings, and directs the intention thus: "May this become a root of virtue for such-and-such a great one; may this very act cause them to be born in a fortunate higher realm" — then, just as directed, that being will be born there, will manifest their body, will say "Excellent!", and having said this, will circumambulate three times and then vanish from sight.

Even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution, abandoned the sacred Dharma, or maligned a noble one — if at the moment of death they see this dhāraṇī mantra written on a wall, all their karmic obscurations will be exhausted. How much more so for one who recites or chants it! That very Tathāgata will himself appear and say: "Noble child, come

here into my presence."

This concludes the Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Complete Purification of All Karmic Obscurations."

Translator's Notes

- The five acts of immediate retribution (Skt. pañcānantarya-karma) are the five gravest karmic acts that lead inevitably to rebirth in the lowest hell: killing one's father, killing one's mother, killing an arhat, wounding a Tathāgata, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha.

The phrase rendered "karmic transmissions passing from one life to the next" translates las gcig nas gcig tu brgyud pa, literally "karma transmitted from one to the next," referring to the chain of karmic inheritance across rebirths.

The phrase "white food" (Skt. śukta or similar) in the lunar-purification ritual likely refers to simple, pure foods such as milk, yogurt, or rice — a recognized ascetic dietary observance in Indo-Tibetan ritual contexts.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.